

Project Proposal

Project Title: JoinGun

Team Members:

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1. Executive Summary

JoinGun is a platform which invites university students to join in activities together, allowing both friends and strangers with shared interests to meet up through posted activities. It includes a map to show exact meeting locations, notifications, and an AI-driven recommendation system that learns from the user's participation history. The goal is to reduce the difficulty of finding activity partners and make coordinating meetups easier and safer for students on campus.

2. Introduction and Problem Statement

Many university students, especially 1st year students, students who find it hard to socialize, or those who recently moved from another area/struggle to find people to join activities with outside of class. Even though universities have many clubs and activities, access to them is spread with no central hub, leading to problems such as:

- Missed opportunities: students don't know when someone is organizing, or looking for others to join, an activity that matches their interests.
- Difficult coordination: logistics(time, location, number of people) are scattered across multiple group social channels, easy to lose track of, with no centralized notifications
- Socially awkward with strangers: there's no safe, trustworthy central space(verified via university email) for meeting new people who share the same activity interests.

- No personalized recommendations: students have to search for activities by themselves; there's no system that learns their interests from past behavior.

Target Users:

- **Primary:**
 1. University students verified via their university email
 2. Students who want to try new activities with people who share their interests, even if they're strangers
- **Secondary:**
 1. University clubs/activity groups looking to recruit for members or participants

3. Project Goals and Objectives

Primary Goal: Build a platform that makes it easy, safe, and relevant for students to find people to do activities with.

Specific Objectives:

- Reduce the time/hassle of coordinating activity logistics
- Increase students' chances of meeting others with shared interests, even strangers
- Reduce the problem of participants being unable to find meeting locations, via a built-in map
- Recommend activities tailored to each user's interests using AI

4. Scope of Work

In-Scope Functionalities:

- Sign-up/verification via university email
- Post activities specifying number of people, location (pinned on a map), and time
- Notifications as the activity time approaches
- Friend system (add manually, or add people from the same activity group)
- AI-based activity recommendations based on participation history

Out-of-Scope Functionalities:

- Payment system for paid activities, Real-time in-app chat

5. Methodology and Technical Approach

- **5.1. Development Methodology:** Agile/Scrum with weekly sprints
- **5.2. System Architecture:**
- **5.3. Technology Stack:**

6. Risk Assessment and Mitigation Plan

- **Safety risk** (meeting strangers in person) → Require verification via university email only; consider adding a report/block feature
- **Data privacy risk** (storing location and behavioral logs) → Restrict data access, define a clear privacy policy
- **Low user adoption risk** (few users at launch) → Start with a small target group within the university, promote through clubs

7. Milestones and Timeline

8. Ethical Considerations

- University email verification to reduce the risk of fake accounts
- Obtaining consent to collect and use user behavior data for recommendations
- Protecting user's location data and personal information
- Responsibility for user safety when meeting in person

9. Expected Deliverables

- A working(MVP) version of the JoinGun app/web app
- Supporting documents: Product Backlog, Design draft(feature list, user journey, diagrams), Compliance document
- A report on user interviews and problem validation

10. Conclusion

JoinGun addresses the lack of a convenient, safe central channel for university students to find activity partners. With features like activity posting, maps, notifications, and AI-based recommendations, the team believes this platform will help increase student engagement in campus activities.

11. References

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